Recovery journey timelines

For Dr Nate Myhill to review. Proposed for drnatemyhill.com.au. Nothing here is on the site yet.

These are draft timelines for each procedure page, written from the patient's point of view. Every timing comes from what that page already says. Where a page gives no timing, the stage has none, and we have not added numbers of our own.

How to reply. For each one, reply with its number and either OK or your change, for example:

1. OK
2. Sling is 3 to 4 weeks, not 4 to 6
3. Remove this one

Items with a yellow note need something from you, such as typical timings the page does not state. You can also talk through them in your Loom videos.

Once you approve them, we will add each timeline to its procedure page.

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1 Rotator cuff repair

Shoulder & upper limb · drnatemyhill.com.au/shoulder-upper-limb/rotator-cuff-repair

Before surgery

You and Dr Myhill talk through your options, the approach and the anaesthetic.

Day of surgery

Most repairs are done under a general anaesthetic, often with a nerve block to reduce pain afterwards.

Most are keyhole surgery, through small cuts.

First weeks in a sling

About 4–6 weeks

Your arm is placed in a sling after surgery.

Rehab with a physio

Starts early

Physiotherapy keeps your shoulder moving at first.

Strengthening exercises come later.

Back to usual activities

Light activities usually by around 3 months

Full recovery typically 6–12 months

How long this takes depends on the size of the tear and how complex the repair is.

Typical only. Recovery varies between people.
Dr Myhill will talk you through your own plan.

☐ OK as is ☐ Change: _____

2 Shoulder replacement

Shoulder & upper limb · drnatemyhill.com.au/shoulder-upper-limb/shoulder-replacement

Before surgery

You and Dr Myhill talk through the design of replacement that suits your shoulder.

Day of surgery

Operation typically 90–120 minutes

Hospital stay typically 1–2 nights

General anaesthetic, usually with a nerve block for pain control.

First weeks in a sling

About 4–6 weeks

Your arm is placed in a sling after surgery.

Rehab with a physio

Starts early

Physiotherapy first restores movement, then moves on to strengthening.

Using your arm again

Comfortable use typically by around 3–6 months

Still improving over 12 months

Typical only. Recovery varies between people.
Dr Myhill will talk you through your own plan.

☐ OK as is ☐ Change: _____

3 Shoulder instability

Shoulder & upper limb · drnatemyhill.com.au/shoulder-upper-limb/shoulder-instability

Before surgery

Dr Myhill reviews your scans and talks through whether surgery is right for you.

Day of surgery

Either a keyhole repair that reattaches the torn rim of the socket using anchors, or a Latarjet operation that adds a piece of bone to the front of the socket.

First weeks in a sling

4–6 weeks

Your arm is placed in a sling after surgery.

Rehab with a physio

Starts early

Physiotherapy begins early to restore movement and strength.

Back to contact sport

Contact sport typically 6–9 months after a keyhole repair

After a Latarjet it can potentially be earlier.

Typical only. Recovery varies between people.
Dr Myhill will talk you through your own plan.

☐ OK as is ☐ Change: _____

4 AC joint surgery

Shoulder & upper limb · drnatemyhill.com.au/shoulder-upper-limb/ac-joint-surgery

Before surgery

Most lower-grade AC joint injuries settle without surgery. Dr Myhill will discuss the most appropriate procedure for you.

Day of surgery

For arthritis, a small amount of bone at the end of the collarbone is removed by keyhole surgery as a day procedure.

For higher-grade separations, the ligaments holding the joint are reconstructed.

After surgery

Dr Myhill will talk you through your recovery.

Typical only. Recovery varies between people.
Dr Myhill will talk you through your own plan.

Note: The page gives no recovery timings, so this one is thin. Please tell us typical timings (sling, return to activities) if you want them shown. The line 'Dr Myhill will talk you through your recovery' is ours, not from the page.

☐ OK as is ☐ Change: _____

5 Biceps tendon surgery

Shoulder & upper limb · drnatemyhill.com.au/shoulder-upper-limb/biceps-tendon-surgery

Before surgery	Day of surgery	After surgery
Many biceps tendon problems settle with physiotherapy. Surgery is considered when symptoms persist.	Typically keyhole. The tendon is released from its attachment in the shoulder, or released and re-secured lower on the arm bone.	Dr Myhill will talk you through your recovery.

Typical only. Recovery varies between people.
Dr Myhill will talk you through your own plan.

Note: The page gives no recovery timings, so this one is thin. Please tell us typical timings if you want them shown. The line 'Dr Myhill will talk you through your recovery' is ours, not from the page.

☐ OK as is ☐ Change: _____

6 Tennis elbow

Shoulder & upper limb · drnatemyhill.com.au/shoulder-upper-limb/tennis-elbow

Before surgery

Non-surgical care first, at least 6–12 months

Surgery is considered when pain has continued despite this treatment.

Day of surgery

The worn tendon tissue at the outer elbow is released or cleaned up, keyhole or through a small cut.

Rest after surgery

Recovery starts with a period of rest.

Rehab with a physio

Over several months

A progressive physiotherapy programme.

Typical only. Recovery varies between people.
Dr Myhill will talk you through your own plan.

☐ OK as is ☐ Change: _____

7 OK procedure

Shoulder & upper limb · drnatemyhill.com.au/shoulder-upper-limb/ok-procedure

Before surgery

Activity changes, physiotherapy, anti-inflammatory medicine or an injection come first. Surgery is considered when symptoms limit daily life and these have not helped.

Day of surgery

In most cases keyhole, through small cuts. Loose pieces are removed and a small window is made in the bone at the back of the elbow so it can straighten more fully.

Rehab with a physio

A supervised programme to regain movement and strength in the elbow.

Typical only. Recovery varies between people.
Dr Myhill will talk you through your own plan.

Note: The page gives no recovery timings. Add any you want shown.

☐ OK as is ☐ Change: _____

8 UCL reconstruction

Shoulder & upper limb · drnatemyhill.com.au/shoulder-upper-limb/ucl-reconstruction

Before surgery

Some people try rest and physiotherapy first. Dr Myhill talks through whether surgery is right for you.

Day of surgery

The damaged ligament is replaced with a graft tendon, from your forearm or a donor.

First weeks in a splint or brace

About 6 weeks

Your elbow is protected in a splint or brace.

Rehab with a physio

Over 4–6 months

Movement first, then strengthening, then sport-specific exercises.

Back to throwing

Throwing **overhead, typically 12–18 months**

Typical only. Recovery varies between people.
Dr Myhill will talk you through your own plan.

☐ OK as is ☐ Change: _____

9 Cubital tunnel syndrome

Shoulder & upper limb · drnatemyhill.com.au/shoulder-upper-limb/cubital-tunnel-syndrome

Before surgery	Day of surgery	After surgery
Mild cases may improve with activity changes, a night splint, padding and physiotherapy. Surgery is considered when symptoms are moderate to severe or persistent.	Usually a day procedure, under general or regional anaesthetic. The tight tissue over the nerve is released. Sometimes the nerve is also moved to the front of the elbow.	Dr Myhill will talk you through your recovery.

Typical only. Recovery varies between people.
Dr Myhill will talk you through your own plan.

Note: The page does not describe recovery. The line 'Dr Myhill will talk you through your recovery' is ours. Add typical timings if you want them shown.

☐ OK as is ☐ Change: _____

10 Carpal tunnel syndrome

Shoulder & upper limb · drnatemyhill.com.au/shoulder-upper-limb/carpal-tunnel-syndrome

Before surgery

Night splints, activity changes or an injection are tried first in milder cases. Release is considered when these fail or the nerve is more seriously affected.

Day of surgery

Usually a day procedure, mostly under local anaesthetic. The tight band over the nerve is cut through a small cut in the palm or by keyhole.

First days

Light activities typically within a few days

Regaining strength

Full hand strength may take several weeks

Nerve recovery can take weeks to months

How long this takes varies between people.

Typical only. Recovery varies between people. Dr Myhill will talk you through your own plan.

☐ OK as is ☐ Change: _____

11 Wrist fractures

Shoulder & upper limb · drnatemyhill.com.au/shoulder-upper-limb/wrist-fractures

Assessing your fracture

Scaphoid fractures often need an MRI or CT scan to confirm. Dr Myhill talks through the best approach for your fracture.

Cast or surgery

Many wrist fractures are treated in a cast or splint. Surgery is considered if the bone is significantly displaced, unstable or involves the joint surface.

If surgery is needed

A metal plate or a small screw holds the bone in place. A plate is usually left in long term, but can be removed if it causes symptoms.

Typical only. Recovery varies between people.
Dr Myhill will talk you through your own plan.

Note: The page does not describe recovery timings. Add any you want shown.

☐ OK as is ☐ Change: _____

12 Total hip replacement

Hip & knee · drnatemyhill.com.au/hip-knee/total-hip-replacement

Before surgery

You and Dr Myhill talk through the bearing surface options, how the parts are fixed and the surgical approach.

Day of surgery

General or spinal anaesthetic.

Walking typically begins on the day of, or the day after, surgery.

In hospital

Typically 2–4 nights

This varies between people.

Rehab with a physio

Several months

A physiotherapy programme continues for several months.

Back to usual activities

Light activities typically within about 6 weeks

Most normal activities by around 3 months

Driving is typically around 6 weeks, once you can safely do an emergency stop and are no longer taking opioid medicines.

Typical only. Recovery varies between people.
Dr Myhill will talk you through your own plan.

Note: Includes 'walking typically begins on the day of or the day after surgery', from the page. This goes with your pending decision on the hip FAQ line 'many patients begin walking on the day of surgery'.

☐ OK as is ☐ Change: _____

13 Total knee replacement

Hip & knee · drnatemyhill.com.au/hip-knee/total-knee-replacement

Before surgery

You and Dr Myhill talk through your goals and your options.

Day of surgery

General or spinal anaesthetic.

A physiotherapist helps you walk within hours of the operation.

In hospital

Typically 2–4 nights

This varies between people.

Rehab with a physio

6–12 weeks

Physiotherapy at home or in a rehabilitation facility. Knee bending improves step by step.

Back to usual activities

Everyday activities **within about 6–12 weeks**

Improvement **continues over about 12 months**

Recovery typically levels off by around 12 months.

Typical only. Recovery varies between people.
Dr Myhill will talk you through your own plan.

Note: 'You and Dr Myhill talk through your goals and your options' is our wording, based on the page's FAQ.

☐ OK as is ☐ Change: _____

14 ACL reconstruction

Hip & knee · drnatemyhill.com.au/hip-knee/acl-reconstruction

Before surgery

You and Dr Myhill decide together, based on your activity goals, symptoms of instability and any other injuries.

You also talk through which tendon graft to use.

Day of surgery

Typically 60–90 minutes

Keyhole surgery through small portals. The torn ligament is replaced with a tendon graft.

Rehab with a physio

Rehab is a graded, step-by-step process.

Strength and function criteria, not time alone, guide each step.

Back to sport

Unrestricted sport typically around 9–12 months

Once strength tests and functional assessments confirm you are ready.

Typical only. Recovery varies between people. Dr Myhill will talk you through your own plan.

☐ OK as is ☐ Change: _____

15 Meniscal repair

Hip & knee · drnatemyhill.com.au/hip-knee/meniscal-repair

Before surgery

Dr Myhill considers whether your tear can be repaired.

This depends on where the tear is, its pattern and the quality of the tissue.

Day of surgery

Keyhole surgery through small portals.

Stitches or implants hold the torn tissue together while it heals.

First weeks: protect the repair

Several weeks

Weight-bearing and sport are restricted so the repaired tissue can heal.

Back to sport

Full return to sport typically 4–6 months

Recovery is more protective than after trimming.

Typical only. Recovery varies between people. Dr Myhill will talk you through your own plan.

☐ OK as is ☐ Change: _____

16 Knee arthroscopy

Hip & knee · drnatemyhill.com.au/hip-knee/knee-arthroscopy

Before surgery

You and Dr Myhill talk through what may be found and treated during the procedure.

Day of surgery

General or regional anaesthetic.

A small camera and instruments go in through small cuts.

Usually a day procedure.

Back to light activity

Typically 1–2 weeks

This applies after a diagnostic arthroscopy or minor meniscal trimming.

After a repair or cartilage procedure

A more protective rehabilitation programme is needed.

Recovery depends on what is done during surgery.

Typical only. Recovery varies between people. Dr Myhill will talk you through your own plan.

☐ OK as is ☐ Change: _____

17 Hip trauma

Hip & knee · drnatemyhill.com.au/hip-knee/hip-trauma

After the injury

Hip fractures need prompt surgical treatment.

Dr Myhill and the hospital trauma team work to arrange it.

Hip surgery

Ideally within 24–48 hours of injury

The fracture is fixed with screws or a nail, or the hip is replaced.

Your recovery

Surgery aims to restore mobility and support your recovery.

Dr Myhill will talk you through what to expect for your injury.

Long-term follow-up

Dr Myhill provides long-term follow-up after injury.

Typical only. Recovery varies between people. Dr Myhill will talk you through your own plan.

Note: Only one timing on the page (surgery ideally within 24 to 48 hours). 'Dr Myhill will talk you through what to expect' is ours.

☐ OK as is ☐ Change: _____

18 Upper limb trauma

Trauma · drnatemyhill.com.au/trauma/upper-limb

After the injury

Dr Myhill treats fractures, dislocations and soft tissue injuries of the shoulder, arm, elbow and wrist.

Your assessment

The right treatment depends on the type of injury, and on your age and activity level.

Your treatment

Some injuries heal without surgery.

Others may need a plate and screws, or a shoulder replacement.

Your recovery

Dr Myhill will talk you through what to expect for your injury.

Typical only. Recovery varies between people. Dr Myhill will talk you through your own plan.

Note: The page gives no timings, so this one is thin. Tell us whether to keep it, add timings, or leave trauma without a timeline.

☐ OK as is ☐ Change: _____

19 Lower limb trauma

Trauma · drnatemyhill.com.au/trauma/lower-limb

After the injury

Dr Myhill treats fractures of the hip, thigh bone, shin bone and ankle.

Hip fractures need prompt treatment.

Your treatment

The right treatment depends on the injury.

Some are treated in a cast or boot. Others need surgery with a rod, or plates and screws.

Getting moving

Some surgery aims to allow early movement of the leg or knee.

Long-term follow-up

Dr Myhill provides long-term follow-up after injury.

Typical only. Recovery varies between people. Dr Myhill will talk you through your own plan.

Note: The page gives no recovery timings. Add any you want shown.

☐ OK as is ☐ Change: _____